

CLA Brand & Design Language OS v1

Section 11 - Accessibility

STATUS: APPROVED

Accessibility Philosophy

- Accessibility is built into every component from the beginning.
- It is never treated as a final checklist or afterthought.

Color Contrast

- All text and interactive elements must meet WCAG accessibility guidelines.
- Readability takes priority over decorative design.

Typography

- Text should be comfortably readable by default.
- Use larger text whenever practical.
- Readability takes priority over fitting more content.

Keyboard Focus

- Every interactive element has a clear visible focus indicator.
- Use the approved Royal Blue focus outline and subtle shadow.

Images

- Every meaningful image includes descriptive alt text.
- Decorative images use empty alt text.

Videos

- Captions are optional in Version 1.
- This may be revisited in a future version.

Forms

- Validation errors use both color and clear explanatory text.
- Users are never required to rely on color alone.

Links

- Links are identifiable through color, hover state, and context.
- Color alone is not sufficient.

Keyboard Navigation

- The entire website must work without a mouse.
- Support Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter, Space, and Escape where applicable.

- Focus order must be logical and predictable.

Testing

- Accessibility is verified on every page before release.
- Testing occurs on desktop, tablet, and mobile.

Browser Zoom

- The website must remain fully usable at up to 200% zoom.
- Layouts must not break.
- Text and navigation must remain usable.

Accessibility Policy

- Accessibility is the default required best practice.
- Rare exceptions may be made only with explicit approval.
- Exceptions must be documented and never become normal practice.